

Assignment 3: Customer Development (CustDev) Report

Course: Technology Entrepreneurship

Project: SUB-CHECK — Cloud-Based Behavioral Anti-Cheat Platform

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Repository: https://github.com/Scirtor/subcheck-anticheat

Status: Draft / Work in Progress (Awaiting Interview Data Collection)

1. Executive Summary

This report outlines the Customer Development (CustDev) study for **SUB-CHECK**, a server-side behavioral anti-cheat platform. The goal of this research is to validate customer jobs, pains, and gains within the competitive gaming market—specifically among competitive players, community organizers, and independent game studios—and test market viability for an OS-agnostic, server-side telemetry approach.

Note: Field data collection is actively ongoing. This document contains the preparation framework, audience segmentation, questionnaire design, and analysis templates.

2. Target Audience Segmentation & Prioritization

To conduct structured Customer Development, our team identified three core audience segments:

Segment	Description	Accessibility (1-5)	Market Volume (1-5)	Impact / Need (1-5)	Priority Rank
Segment A: Competitive & Ranked Gamers	Active players in ranked FPS games (CS2, Valorant, Apex Legends, R6 Siege) playing >10 hrs/week.	5 (High — Discord, Reddit, peers)	5 (Massive — tens of millions)	4 (Directly impacted by cheaters & rootkits)	P1 (Primary)

Segment B: Community Admins & Tournament Hosts	Organizers of collegiate esports, amateur tournament brackets, and dedicated community servers.	4 (Medium-High — university clubs, clan hubs)	3 (Moderate — thousands of organizers)	5 (Critical — manual demo reviews cause burnout)	**P2 (Secondary) **
Segment C: Indie & Mid-Tier Game Studios	Developers building commercial multiplayer titles without multimillion-dollar R&D budgets.	3 (Moderate — itch.io, indie discords)	3 (Growing segment — thousands of studios)	5 (Extremely high — enterprise AC is unaffordable)	**P3 (Strategic B2B)**

3. Customer Discovery Methodology

Our interview framework adheres to *The Mom Test* principles:

- Focus on past behavior rather than hypothetical opinions.
- Avoid pitching the solution during discovery questions.
- Probe into emotional and financial costs of dealing with cheating and anti-cheat software.

Primary Hypotheses to Test:

1. ****Kernel Driver Friction:**** Players experience technical instability (crashes, BSOD) and privacy concerns with Ring 0 drivers.
2. ****Hardware Exploit Gap:**** Competitive organizers face growing evasion by hardware cheats (DMA cards, mouse macros) that client anti-cheats cannot reliably detect.
3. ****Platform Incompatibility:**** Linux and handheld (Steam Deck) gamers are disproportionately locked out by modern client anti-cheats.
4. ****Indie Developer Barrier:**** Indie multiplayer developers lack affordable, lightweight anti-cheat solutions.

4. Quantitative & Statistical Analysis (Placeholder)

****[WORK IN PROGRESS: DATA COLLECTION IN PROGRESS]****

Target: Minimum 30 respondents (or 5 recorded in-depth video sessions).

Raw data is recorded in `questionnaire/responses.csv` and processed in `analysis/analysis.xlsx`.

Visualizations to be inserted:

- Figure 1: Audience Segment Distribution (`analysis/charts/respondent\_segment\_distribution.png`)
- Figure 2: Perception of Kernel-Level Anti-Cheats (`analysis/charts/sentiment\_kernel\_anticheat.png`)
- Figure 3: Receptiveness to Server-Side Behavioral Approach
(`analysis/charts/attitude\_towards\_serverside.png`)
- Figure 4: Cheater Encounter Frequency (`analysis/charts/cheater\_encounter\_frequency.png`)
- Figure 5: Willingness to Participate in Prototype Pilot (`analysis/charts/willingness\_to\_pilot.png`)

5. Key Customer Insights & Interview Transcripts (Placeholder)

****[WORK IN PROGRESS: INTERVIEWS UNDERWAY]****

Direct quotes, recorded interview summaries, and key takeaways will be documented here upon completion of interviews.

Supporting notes will be stored in `evidence/interview\_notes/` and `evidence/screenshots/`.

6. Business Idea & Model Updates (Post-CustDev)

****[WORK IN PROGRESS]****

Changes to the Value Proposition Canvas, pricing strategy, and product roadmap will be finalized based on analyzed respondent feedback.

7. Conclusion & Next Steps

Following data collection and synthesis, the final findings and updated business model will be compiled into the final submission report and presentation deck.